

Presenting Website Recommendations

Client Name: **Jane Roe**

Website Type: **Florist**

Project Background and Description

The client is a florist based in Calgary, Alberta. Her newly launched floral shop is quickly garnering attention and returning customers, and she is looking to capitalize on this rise in demand by expanding the business online. The main goals set for this website is to strengthen the brand's growing identity and to broaden the scope of its customer reach.

There are common challenges that florist websites face that the client wishes to avoid with the creation of the business' website. Namely:

1. Misrepresentation of the arrangements because of the pictures used
2. The layout is convoluted due to the range of categories needed
3. Challenges in differentiating one store from another

Solutions

In order to tackle these problems, I have written a number of solutions to combat each of them and avoid their interference with the customers' purchasing experience.

1. Multiple, minimally edited photos will be used for each product
 - Misrepresentation often occurs because the photos displayed show limited angles and are heavily edited to enhance the arrangement's colours, negating these can help solve the issue.
2. The website's navigation bar will utilize dropdown menus
 - This will enable the website to hide the array of categories the floral shop provides, and to simultaneously highlight the "featured" categories on the navigation bar.
3. The website will stick to a distinct colour scheme and design language
 - A lot of what makes brand identity are the colours used and design language involved.

To implement these proposed solutions, a no-code CMS will be used. As florist websites do not rely on features that require heavy coding and are picture-based, writing new and unique lines of code for it is not needed. Additionally, as the website will need constant updates, it is vital that the florists understand how to navigate and enact these updates on their own.

Limitations

Though most of the proposed solutions do not provide major setbacks, there is one that may interfere with the smoothness of the website's performance. Dedicating multiple photos for each product could cause the website to lag and reduce its efficiency, which would affect both the client and the customers viewing the website. Unfortunately, with a no-code CMS, lazy loading images cannot be implemented into the website.

To combat this, the images must be optimized to lighten its impact on the website's performance. It is vital that the images are compressed and are exported as the .WebP format.

Feature Options and Priority List

High Priority

1. **Addressing potential issues with the UI design**

- Because of the range of events Florists cater to, listing them all down can make the website difficult to navigate and even prevent someone to see certain aspects of the website. With this, it is vital to make the design simpler and sleeker and to ensure that customers will be able to use the website efficiently.
- Additionally, optimizing the website for mobile devices will be prioritized.

2. **Differentiating the brand from other stores**

- To help the store stand out from other shops, the brand's identity will remain consistent and uniform throughout the design. Additionally, this aspect will be heavily dictated by the quality of its UX and UI design, so it is vital that the design excels in catering to the users.

Medium Priority

1. **Ensuring that the display photos represent the arrangement accurately**

- The issue often lies with an arrangement being displayed with only a singular, heavily edited photo. To tackle this, the store's website will display multiple angles of the arrangement with its only edits being minimal and necessary.

2. **Addressing outdated-looking web design**

- To avoid this, the website will be sticking to a specific colour scheme, use a maximum of three fonts, and paying attention to how elements are placed.

Low Priority

1. **Address Confirmation**

- This will display the address the customer typed in, allowing them to recheck the address before placing the order.

2. **Preemptive Delay Warning**

- While delays are usually caused by uncontrollable and unexpected situations, there are times where it can be foreseen (e.g.: bad weather) and in those situations, the website will let the customer know that there could be potential delays.

Time Estimates

1. Developing the website's concept 5 hours

This includes defining the client's goals, analyzing the business' target audience, and determining the features that will be considered as the designing process furthers along.

2. Choosing a no-code CMS platform 1 hour

This stage of the process will be relatively quick as there are already previous research that can help with deciding on a platform to use.

3. Designing the website's structure 5 hours

Some aspects of the layout will have already been decided in the initial development stage, shortening the time allocated for this stage of the process.

4. Wireframing 2 days

The utilization of a no-code CMS shortens the time this stage takes up. However, there are a lot of categories needed to include when it comes to floral products, which contributes greatly to the time estimate.

5. Testing the website 1 day

The time estimate for this stage considers testing the website and fixing any problems that occur during the screen test. However, this stage's time estimate is much more flexible as website malfunctions can be unpredictable.